

COURSE FILE

PC753: Fundamentals of Filmmaking

Credit Structure: 2-0-4-4

Program: MDes (Communication Design)

Year: 1

Semester: 2

Duration: 16 Days (Full Day – Lecture + Studio)

Timing: 9 AM – 6 PM

Course Instructor: Anirban Dutta Gupta

Couse Placement: Core course for MDes (CD) Semester 2. This is a specialised course in design and is aimed at integrating inputs provided in previous courses in semester 1 and 2 into a 'multimedia' matrix and orient the students to its multimodal application.

Course Format: Module based. The course is taught as a combination of Lectures and Studio sessions. Lectures introduce concepts, which are then analysed and explored via studio sessions and assignments. Lecture and studio is integrated and in certain cases can overlap. Teaching is through hand-on learning and through learning-by-doing and via real-time demonstrations and guidance by faculty members. Students will be expected to conduct fieldwork.

Course Objective and Content:

The terms film and video is used interchangeably.

The objective of this course is to introduce the various aspects of filmmaking – from concept till production. The course will synthesize and integrate the theoretical inputs the students

have received in course 'Multi-modal storytelling', technical and creative inputs during 'Basics of Photography' and 'Image, Text, Sound' course and expose them to the professional methodology and structured approach of constructing a filmic narrative and its execution, leading to a final finished film – whether it is a fictionalized story or a story from the real world in the documentary genre.

This course not just aims to introduce the students to the complex world of film production but to also introduce them to complicated and multi-modal production workflow where different mediums have to be seamlessly integrated to create a complete product. While film and filmmaking, as a medium, is extraordinarily valuable; the core learning from this course is to gain greater appreciation of planning, budgeting, logistics, human-resource management, storytelling and narration and integrating different visual (and auditory) mediums into a coherent communication.

Course Abstract:

The art of filmmaking is a complex process requiring perfect synthesis of multiple elements from domains of storytelling, narrative, photography, design, technology, physics and management. This course will give an overview and introduction to this world and expose the students to the various elements that go into conceiving, planning and executing a motion film project.

One of the aspect that the course will look at in detail is 'continuity of filmic time and space' and hopefully realize that it is a grammar that has come about, based on our natural sense of editing, and which has been adapted to the art and craft of filmic space. To understand this better the course will look at the history of filmic narrative construction, tracing from actuality films of Lumiere Brothers through Edwin S Porter and D W Griffith, Pudovkin' theories of Constructive Editing and Eisenstein' Thematic Editing and Intellectual Montages. One will see how these early masters explored and laid down the basic grammar of film narrative which is followed even today, though with modifications to assimilate the current

refined film sense. The course will look at the counterpoints placed by Andre Bazin and his appreciation of the neo-realist film form. One will also see how, historically, the Indian film industry (not just Bollywood) has matched and mirrored the developments in Europe and the United States.

Based on this historical overview the course will explore the various principles of filmic construction – the narrative, storytelling, continuity, smoothness, cutting point, image size and angles, sense of direction, overlapping, cross cutting. The course will explore the idea of ‘real’ time versus ‘reel’ time and the illusion of ‘continuousness of narrative’ or continuity. We will also look at temporal and spatial continuity and how these can be maintained while translating it into a video/film production. We will see how cinematography, lighting, sound and editing all assist in the creation of continuity.

The course will try and assimilate these inputs and explore how they can be incorporated into a video production. To achieve this, the students will script, storyboard and direct short fiction films and documentaries. The execution of these films will be done in a professional manner following the three-stage film production routine: pre-production stage, production stage and post production stage. In the process, the students will experience the intricacies of film production, production management, art direction, cinematography, acting etc.

An overview will also be provided on a typical studio set-up. The course will also be exploring video as a technological medium and compare the pros and cons of video production versus the film production with special emphasis on how to work around the restrictions posed by video, and how using various optical tricks can ‘cheat’ the minds-eye into believing that the quality of product is better than what it is. In this regard, the course will explore cinematography using the video camera and basic lighting techniques.

Students are encouraged to recall the learnings from the Photography module as there are multiple overlaps between photography and filmmaking.

Knowledge and Skill targets:

Knowledge:

1. Understanding of film
2. Film language and grammar
3. Film semiotics
4. Constructing a narrative
5. Translation of thought into narrative to physical product
6. Understanding sound
7. Diegetic, Non-Diegetic, Trans-diegetic and Intra-Diegetic sound
8. Sound and emotion
9. Visualising and planning sound
10. Sound, Image, Text and culture
11. Impact of sound, image and text in communication design
12. Deploying as multimedia assets
13. Film as a communication product
14. Different film formats and its deployment
15. Lighting
16. Language of edit

Skill:

1. Scripting and narrative construction
2. Production planning
3. Camera use and understanding technical parameters and its results
4. Understanding light and its use
5. Editing- visual and sound
6. Recording and creating soundscape
7. Video editing software

8. Sound and image editing software
9. Multimedia integration software
10. Organising sound recording setup

Softwares:

1. Adobe Premiere Pro
2. Adobe Animate
3. Adobe Audition
4. Audacity

Hardware:

1. Camera
2. Lights
3. Edit systems
4. Sound recording equipments (zoom mic, microphones, boom rods)
5. Sound studio

Assessment Method: Continuous assessment of application of concepts through the duration of the course, along with assessment of group and individual assignments given. Assessment will not only cover the assignments, but professionalism, precision, pride, care and discipline displayed by the students.

P1	P2	P3	P4	P5	P6	P7	P8	P9	P10	P11	P12
	X	X	X	X		X	X	X	X	X	X

Course Outcome:

The course aims to equip the students with professional knowledge –creative, narrative and technical – involving the art and craft of videography. This course prepares the students for professional application of videography as a communication and storytelling device and lays the groundwork for further specialized courses in this field.

Growth Matrix:

Flow	Objectives
1	Goal 1: Introduction to film history & Narrative Objective: To understand and appreciate the evolution of film language and process
2	Goal 2: Basics of Film language Objective: To understand the grammar of films
3	Goal 3: Cause & Effect Objective: Appreciating causality and juxtaposition as driving force for film language
4	Goal 4: Understanding Continuity Objective: Continuity as the fabric that holds narrative together
5	Goal 5: Scripting Objective: Translation of thought and imagination into an actionable format
6	Goal 6: Cinematographic Techniques and methods Objective: Understanding the camera, the image making technologies, its manipulation

7	Goal 7: Production Planning and Management Objective: Translating the script into actionable and practical deliverable format
8	Goal 8: Film production Objective: Planning and executing an entire production from script to shoot
9	Goal 9: Editing principals Objective: Integrating image, sound & film language for the creation of a complete time-based product
10	Goal 10: Studio sound recording techniques and principals Objective: Integrating image and sound for a specific emotional communication package

Some things to keep in mind:

- Attendance is mandatory. You will have to be present during class hours.
- All assignments have to be completed.
- Use of any form of AI tools to generate concepts is strictly forbidden unless discussed in class and allowed for the specific assignment.

Reference:

1. Understanding Movies (*Louis Giannetti*)
2. The technique of Film Editing (*Karel Reisz & Gavin Miller*)
3. In the blink of an Eye (*Walter Murch*)
4. The oxford history of World Cinema
5. Film Form & Film Sense (*Sergei Eisenstein*)
6. Five 'C' of Cinematography (*Joseph V Mascelli*)

7. Single Camera Video Production (*Robert B Musburger*)
8. Non-Fiction Film: A Critical History (*Richard M Barsam*)
9. Close-Up: A critical perspective on film (*Marsha Kinder & Beverle Houston*)
10. Painting with Light (*John Alton*)
11. Lighting for Digital Video & Television (*John Jackman*)
12. Producing & Directing the Short Film and Video (*Peter Rea & David K Irving*)
13. Video Editing: A Postproduction (*Primer Steven E Browne*)
14. Signs and Meaning in the Cinema (*Peter Wollen*)
15. The technique of Documentary Film Production (*W Hugh Baddeley*)
16. Speaking of Films (*Satyajit Ray*)
17. 17.Practices of Looking: An introduction to Visual Culture (*Marita Sturken & Lisa Cartwright*)
18. Visual Awareness and Design (*Phillip Thiel*)
19. Film Direction: Shot by Shot (*Steven D Katz*)
20. Story Sense (*Paul Lucey*)
21. Cinematography: Theory & Practice (*Blain Brown*)
22. Setting up your shots (*Jeremy Vineyard*)
23. Double Take: Looking at the Documentary (*Raqs Media Collective*)
24. Documentary Film Classics (*William Rothman*)
25. Film Theory and Philosophy (*Richard Allen & Murray Smith*)
26. Representing Reality (*Bill Nichols*)
27. Basics of Video Lighting (*Des Yver & Graham Swainson*)
28. The History of Cinema for Beginners (*Jarek Kupsc*)
29. Key concepts in Communication and Cultural Studies (*Tom O'Sullivan, John Hartley, Danny Saunders, Martin Montgomery & John Fiske*)
30. The Visual Culture Reader (*Nicholas Mirzoeff*)
31. Corporate Media Production (*Ray DiZazzo*)
32. Film as Art (*Rudolf Arnheim*)
33. The Subject of Cinema (*Gaston Roberge*)

34. The Technique of Film & Video Editing: History, Theory and Practice (*Ken Dancyger*)
35. Digital Moviemaking (*Scott Billups*)

Essential Films (To be watched in the sequence provided. Most of the titles are available on Youtube/Netflix/MUBI and as DVDs in the MDes Studio):

Fiction

1. Great Train Robbery (*Edwin Porter*)
2. Birth of a Nation (*D W Griffith*)
3. Cabinet of Dr. Caligari (*Robert Wiene*)
4. Le Règle de Jeu (*Jean Renoir*)
5. The Jazz Singer (*Alan Crosland*)
6. City Lights (*Charles Chaplin*)
7. M (*Fritz Lang*)
8. Citizen Kane (*Orson Welles*)
9. La rivière du hibou (*Robert Enrico*)
10. The Bicycle Thief (*Vittorio De Sica*)
11. Mother India (*Mehboob Khan*)
12. Do Bigha Zameen (*Bimal Roy*)
13. Rome, Open City (*Roberto Rossellini*)
14. Neech Nagar (*Chetan Anand*)
15. Wild Strawberry (*Ingmar Bergman*)
16. 400 Blows (*Francois Truffaut*)
17. Fireman's Ball (*Milos Forman*)
18. Pather Panchali (*Satyajit Ray*)
19. Weekend (*Jean Luc-Godard*)
20. Ajantrik (*Ritwik Ghatak*)
21. Abhijan (*Satyajit Ray*)
22. Jules et Jim (*Francois Truffaut*)
23. Bhuvan Shome (*Mrinal Sen*)
24. Megha Dhaka Tara (*Ritwik Ghatak*)
25. Charulata (*Satyajit Ray*)
26. La Dolce Vita (*Frederico Fellini*)
27. Rashomon (*Akira Kurosawa*)
28. Z (*Costas Gavras*)

29. Tokyo Monogatari (*Yasujiro Ozu*)
30. Singin' in the Rain (*Gene Kelly/Stanley Donen*)
31. Annie Hall (*Woody Allen*)
32. Full Metal Jacket (*Stanley Kubrik*)
33. One flew over the Cuckoo's nest (*Milos Forman*)
34. Hare Rama Hare Krishna (*V Devanand*)
35. The Godfather (*Francis Ford Coppola*)
36. Swayamvaram (*Adoor Gopalakrishnan*)
37. Goodbye, Lenin (*Wolfgang Becker*)
38. Run Lola Run (*Tom Tykwer*)
39. Amelie (*Jean-Pierre Jeunet*)
40. 2001: A Space Odyssey (*Stanley Kubrick*)
41. Ship of Theseus (*Anand Gandhi*)
42. Macbeth (*Justin Kurzel*)
43. Throne of Blood (*Akira Kurosawa*)
44. Maqbool (*Vishal Bharadwaj*)
45. Omkara (*Vishal Bharadwaj*)
46. Hazaaron Khwaishein Aisi (*Sudhir Mishra*)
47. Three Colours: Blue (*Kristof Kieslowski*)
48. Three Colours: White (*Kristof Kieslowski*)
49. Three Colours: Red (*Kristof Kieslowski*)

Non-Fiction/Documentaries:

50. Nanook of the North (*Robert Flaherty*)
51. Man with the Movie Camera (*Dziga Vertov*)
52. Triumph of the Will (*Leni Riefenstahl*)
53. La Sang de Betes (*Georges Franju*)
54. Nightmail (*John Grierson/Harry Watt/Basil Wright*)
55. In the forest hangs a bridge (*Sanjay Kak*)
56. Koyaanisqatsi (*Godfrey Reggio*)
57. San Soleil (*Chris Marker*)
58. Bowling for Columbine (*Michael Moore*)
59. Ram ke Naam (*Anand Patwardhan*)
60. Human (*Yann Arthus-Bertrand*)